

Checklist for Creating a Gold-Standard Annotated Dataset for your Research Project

Pre-Annotation

- ☐ Data selected is relevant to project objectives with diverse scenarios, stratified across key variables, use and edge cases
- ☐ Dataset includes adequate sample size
- ☐ Data cleaned and prepared: noise, duplicates, and irrelevant information removed
- ☐ Deidentification performed to remove PHI in accordance with HIPAA (when applicable)
- ☐ Ontology created with well-defined key terms and labeling criteria
- ☐ Comprehensive annotation guidelines created
- ☐ Annotators with relevant domain expertise or annotation experience recruited and trained
- ☐ Test annotations completed and reviewed

During-Annotation

- ☐ Iterative Quality Control Implemented
 - ☐ Disagreements and issues addressed and guidelines updated
 - ☐ Changes are version controlled and documented
 - ☐ Annotators retrained as necessary
- ☐ Inter-annotator agreement chosen and metrics tracked
- ☐ Regular communication and progress tracking occurs

Post-Annotation

- ☐ Final dataset quality score and select metric documented
 - ☐ IAA score
- ☐ Final quality audit performed
- ☐ Documentation created
 - ☐ Ontology exported
 - ☐ Annotated Data Results exported
 - ☐ Annotation Card created
- ☐ Dataset check for PHI and removed, anonymized, or documented
- ☐ Archival Plan
- ☐ Sharing Plan